

Lecture 6

Understanding the Character Building.

Seven Sins, Role of Teachers and Parents.

The Views of Swami Vivekananda, Mahatma
Gandhi and Abdul Kalam

Seven Sins

According to Mahatma Gandhi

- 1) Politics without Principles: Especially the one where the pursuit of truth is given up by the politicians.
- 2) Wealth without Work: Like in Zamindari system.
- 3) Pleasure without Conscience: Like Addictions.
- 4) Knowledge without Character: Like lucrative Career.

- 5) Commerce without Morality: Like Cheating and Corruption.
- 6) Science without Humanity: Example when is used for destruction.
- 7) Worship without Sacrifice: Worship means here that Truth is God and Sacrifice involves spirituality, compassion and understanding.

The Art of Character Building

In views of Swami Vivekananda

- Swami Vivekananda said, “...it is the character that cleaves its way through adamant walls of difficulties”.
- He explained that neither money, nor name, nor fame, nor learning that pays, but only love.

What does it mean to: Develop the Character?

- 1) Strength and Gentleness,
- Consistence in both of these aspects of character.
- 2) Broadmindedness and Faith.
- 3) Fearlessness and Compassion

Benefits of Building a strong Inner Self and Character

- 1) Withstand the non-sense in life
- 2) Remain Undistracted
- 3) Work for the chosen field.

Abdul Kalam about the Role of Teachers and Parents in Character Building of Children

- A teacher should have a creative minds.
- Great teachers emanate out of knowledge, passion and compassion.
- If a country is to be corruption free and become a nation of beautiful minds, only teachers and parents can make a difference.
- Teaching is a very noble profession that shapes the character, caliber and future of an individual.

- The purpose of education is to make good human beings with skill and expertise.
- Enlightened human beings can be created by teachers.
- Creativity is key to the success in the future and primary education is where teachers can bring creativity in children at that level.